

MAYESO CHINSEU LAZARO, PHD
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OTHER POSITIONS/DESIGNATIONS
Managing Director, Nthanda Consulting, Malawi
Managing Partner, Kula Consultants, Malawi
Technical Expert, Fructuous Consulting, South Africa
Technical Advisor, CITS, Uganda¹

BRIEF PROFILE

Dr Mayeso Chinseu Lazaro is a Senior Lecturer, Researcher, and Evaluation Consultant at the University of Malawi, with over 15 years of academic and research and evaluation experience. He holds an interdisciplinary PhD in Human Geography and Social Sciences from the University of Hull, England, United Kingdom, a Master of Science in Family Ecology and Practice from the University of Alberta, Edmonton, Canada, and a Bachelor of Education Humanities from the University of Malawi, Zomba, Malawi. His teaching, research, consultancy, and outreach activities focus on children, youth, and families, as well as older persons and ageing populations. Recently, he has developed an avid interest in the intersections of climate change and ageing as well as digital sociology, particularly digital ageism. He is an expert in qualitative research methodologies.

Dr Lazaro is the Managing Director of Nthanda Consulting (Malawi), Managing Partner of Kula Consultants (Malawi), Technical Expert for Fructuous Consulting (South Africa), and Technical Advisor, for Center for Institutional and Technical Support for Civil Society Organizations (CITS, Uganda). He has over a decade of consultancy experience and has served as Lead, Associate, and Local Evaluation Consultant on baseline, midline, and endline evaluations, as well as strategic planning in early childhood development (ECD). He has worked with community, district and national stakeholders, and government ministries, universities, and international NGOs, such as Save the Children, UNICEF, Ubongo International, ActionAid, Project Concern International, and BBC Media Action. He has also worked as a Local Consultant for various consultancies serving local and international firms, including Kadale Consultants (UK/Malawi), Syspons (Germany), Economic Sense (Germany/South Africa), and Fructuous Consulting (South Africa).

Dr Lazaro has recently led or contributed to three externally funded projects at the University of Malawi in the area of early childhood development (ECD): 1) Strengthening Malawi's ECD Management Information System (USAID-funded); 2) Scaling Up the Child-to-Child Play-Based Learning Approach (IDRC-funded); and 3) the Complementary Feeding Bowl Pilot (UNICEF-funded). He has also collaborated with the Government of Malawi and UNICEF on key ECD and nutrition initiatives,

¹ Center for Institutional and Technical Support for Civil Society Organizations

including the development of an ECD Nutrition Training Manual and Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for Nutrition Programmes during COVID-19.

EDUCATION

- Interdisciplinary Doctor of Philosophy (PhD), Human Geography and Social Sciences, University of Hull, United Kingdom, 2018 (Funded by the University of Hull Studentship – International Fee Bursary)
- Postgraduate Certificate in Research Training, University of Hull, United Kingdom, 2016
- Master of Science (MSc) in Family Ecology and Practice, University of Alberta, Canada, 2013
- Bachelor of Education (BEd.) Humanities (with Credit), University of Malawi, Malawi, 2007

MERIT-BASED ACADEMIC AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

1. University of Hull Studentship, University of Hull, UK (2015–2018).
2. Mary Louise Imrie Graduate Student Award, University of Alberta, Canada (January, 2012).
3. Louise Davies Memorial Graduate Scholarship, University of Alberta, Canada (September 2011).
4. Engberg Graduate Scholarship in International Home Economics, University of Alberta, Canada (September 2011).
5. University of Alberta Graduate Students' Association Professional Development Grant, University of Alberta, Canada (December 21, 2012).
6. Malawi Government Scholarship for Junior Staff Development (July 2010 – August 2012).

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

- Programme and project monitoring and evaluation (baselines, midlines, and endlines)
- Qualitative research: in-depth interviews (IDIs), key-informant interviews (KIIs), photovoice, drawing-elicited interviews, focus group discussions (FGDs), ethnographies, and stakeholder consultations
- Qualitative data management and analysis
- Research team training, field supervision, and leadership
- Stakeholder engagement and high-level consultation
- Evidence-based policy advising and report writing
- Microsoft Office Suite and qualitative data analysis software (NVivo)

THEMATIC AREAS OF INTEREST

- Children, youth, and family well-being.
- Early Childhood Development (ECD) and education policy and practice.
- Ageing, intergenerational relations, and social support systems.
- Digital sociology, particularly digital ageism in the African context.
- Gender, social protection, and community-based development
- Qualitative and mixed-methods research design.

CONSULTANCY AND APPLIED RESEARCH UNDERTAKEN

The following engagements reflect applied research, evaluation, and advisory roles undertaken alongside academic responsibilities.

1. **Local Consultant** – External Evaluation of the Project ‘French Language in Malawi: Strengthening the Teaching and Learning of French in Malawi’.

Client: Fructuous Consulting / French Embassy. **June 2025 – February 2026.**

Value: €19,998.81

Description of assignment and deliverables: Conducted document review and capture insights; designed data collection Instruments; coordinated local fieldwork/data collection in Blantyre; conducted local fieldwork/data collection (qualitative and quantitative); transcribed qualitative collected data, data coding and analysis, wrote draft evaluation report; attended feedback and recommendations workshop; and finalised evaluation report.

2. **Lead Consultant** – Data Collection (FGDs, KIIs) for BBC Media Action’s Formative Research in Malawi: Assessing Young People’s Engagement with Digital Content.

Client: BBC Media Action. **May – June 2024.**

Value: US\$6,441.79

Description of assignment and deliverables: Recruited FGD and IDI participants; conducted FGDs, took detailed observational notes during the FGDs, capturing non-verbal cues and group dynamics; summarised FGD findings comprehensively and insightfully, providing qualitative analysis and key takeaways for the research team; conducted IDIs; recruited participants for online interviews with BBC researchers.; Provide verbatim transcripts of all interviews conducted in English; and submit labelled audio files for each interview.

3. **Lead Consultant** – Data Collection (FGDs, KIIs, Ethnographies) for Ubongo’s ECD Caregiver Formative Evaluation in Malawi; and Ubongo’s ECD Resource Libraries Pilot Evaluation in Malawi.

Client: Ubongo International. **October – December 2023.**

Value: USD22,999.95

Description of assignment and deliverables: Conducted data collection in Lilongwe urban, Dzaleka refugee camp (Dowa), and Blantyre rural areas for the

Caregiver Formative Research and Resource Libraries Pilot Evaluation in Community-Based Childcare Centres (CBCCs); took audio recordings of the focus group discussions and in-depth interviews and notes from the ethnographies; take photographs of data collection activities; fill out debrief templates and attend daily debrief sessions; and transcribed in English all the audios.

4. **Lead Consultant** – Political Economy Analysis for Save the Children’s ECD Programming and Development of an ECD Strategy aligned with the Country Strategic Plan 2022–2024.

Client: Save the Children. **September 30, 2022 – November 10, 2022.**

Value: MWK29,999.000 (~US\$29,411)

Description of assignment and deliverables:

Assessed Save the Children’s substantial ECD portfolio, looking at the various approaches of implementation, and their impact, analysed the political economy of the ECD sector in Malawi and provided recommendations on how Save the Children can best support the Government of Malawi’s efforts to improve coverage and quality of ECD service provision in Malawi, in terms of its programming and advocacy efforts. Specifically, this involved the following key aspects:

- a) Developed a comprehensive picture of SC’s ECD work in Malawi since 1983. This included the following tasks: reviewed SC-Malawi ECD project reports dating back to 1983; consulted Save the Children USA documentation data where information was missing in Malawi; interviewed relevant stakeholders in Malawi on ECD programming, including children in community-based childcare centres (CBCCs) and grade 1 primary schools, parents, caregivers in CBCCs, frontline workers, and district officers in Zomba, Chiradzulu, Mchinji, Ntcheu, Mzimba South, and Nkhata-Bay; and documented the strengths and weaknesses of SC ECD programming since 1983.
- b) Evaluated Save the Children Malawi’s competitiveness against peer NGOs in service provision and advocacy in ECD, leading to the 2030 ambition. This included: engaging top ECD programming organisations for review; highlighting their approaches, innovation, major contributions and vision for the future of their ECD work; and articulating how SC stands against its peers on service provision, advocacy and policy influencing.
- c) Established the Government’s ECD policy and strategy evolution, flagging out potential sub-thematic areas defining the journey to Vision 2063. This included: Conducting power mapping of key stakeholders investing in ECD and their interests; interviewing relevant government experts and development partners on vision, priorities, and most strategic investments needed to expand coverage of quality ECD provision; and identifying areas where Save the Children could add value and help shape government ECD priorities.
- d) SC-Malawi ECD strategy for 2022–2024 and beyond, linking the current Save the Children global and Country Strategic Plan and government NESIP 2020–2030 designed. This encompassed: organising a multi-stakeholder strategy development workshop for ECD in Save the Children -Malawi from 2022–2024 and beyond using the recommendations of objectives 1–3 above as major reference material; writing an ECD strategy for 2022–2024 and beyond using

the results of the multi-stakeholder workshop; debriefing SC-Malawi leadership on the draft strategy; and submitting a final version of the strategy in both soft and hard copies.

- e) Wrote a comprehensive ECD political economy analysis report and ECD strategy for Save the Children aligned to 2022–2024 Country Strategic Plan.

5. **Qualitative Data Analyst** – Development of Malawi’s Food and Nutrition Research Agenda: Stakeholder Consultations.

Client: LUANAR CENTER Project (funded by Irish Aid). **September 2021.**

Value: MWK500,000 (~US\$614.67)

Description of assignment and deliverables: Analysed the stakeholder consultations’ qualitative data that was used to develop a questionnaire for the second round of stakeholder consultations for the development of the National Food and Nutrition Research Agenda; consolidated the research themes, focus areas and research questions from the stakeholders under each priority area; present the findings to the Technical Working Group for Research (TWG-R) for review, and incorporated inputs to the findings; received and consolidated feedback on research report; compile a report on the process followed for analysis of data from stakeholder consultations; and wrote a full report.

6. **Consultant** – Endline Evaluation of the 10-Year ECD Programme.

Client: ActionAid Malawi (funded by the Roger Federer Foundation). **27 May 2021 – August 2021.**

Value: MWK23,002,000 (~US\$28,980)

Description of assignment and deliverables: Assessed the relevance of the ECD initiative from a national and historical perspective, looking back to the context in 2010, when the ECD initiative started, how innovative and cost-effective the chosen approach was, how the community-driven set-up led to sustainability, and how scalable the approach was for third actors, including the government, donors, and the community. Also, provided general learnings, highlighted key results from ActionAid Malawi’s interventions, including best practices, and highlighted and confirmed successes, challenges and recommendations that could support ECD stakeholders, including government, the donor and implementing partners to improve future ECD programming. Collected and analysed data from 10 districts across Malawi (Nsanje, Neno, Phalombe, Machinga, Dedza, Lilongwe, Mchinji, Ntchisi, Chitipa, and Rumphi).

7. **Expert** – Development of Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for Child and Maternal Nutrition Programmes during the COVID-19 Pandemic.

Client: Government of Malawi (funded by UNICEF). **May 2020.**

Value: DSAs

Description of assignment and deliverables: Data collection and development of SOPs.

8. **Consultant** – Development of the National Positive Gender Socialisation Training Package (PGSTP) for ECD in Malawi.

Client: UNICEF. **October 2019 – March 2020.**

Value: US\$37,646.69

Description of assignment and deliverables: Conducted a literature review of relevant ECD-related research, ECD policy and legal frameworks governing the

delivery of ECD services; produced an Assessment Report with clear gender issues in ECD programming, recommendations and a draft outline for the training package; and

developed a Positive Gender Socialisation Training Package (PGSTP) for community caregivers to guide in positive parenting, stimulation and learning of children from zero to five years, both in CBCC and community-related outreach activities. The Package aimed to promote positive parenting and equitable treatment of boys and girls in families, communities, and preschools/ECD/CBCC centres, as well as guide capacity building of caregivers in CBCCs in gender responsive pedagogy

9. **Expert** – Development of the Integrated Nutrition, Early Stimulation and Nurturing Training Manual.

Client: Government of Malawi (funded by UNICEF). **October 2019 – 2021.**

Value: DSAs

Description of assignment and deliverables:

Participated in working sessions at the national level that led to the development of the Integrated Nutrition, Early Stimulation and Nurturing Training Manual; reviewed and edited multiple draft versions of this Manual; served as a Trainer of Trainers (ToT) for the Investing in Early Years Project (IEYP); drafted three modules for the Training Manual, namely: Modules 4 (Communication), 12 (Community Mobilisation and Empowerment), and 13 (Monitoring, Evaluation, and Supportive Supervision); and facilitated training sessions to equip practitioners with skills in early childhood development (ECD), thereby enhancing the quality of service delivery to young children in the country.

10. **Expert and Manual Editor** – Improving Secondary Education in Malawi (ISEM) Project Phases I & II.

Client: Government of Malawi (funded by the EU). **March 2020 – June 2023.**

Project Value: €36,409

Description of assignment and deliverables: Participated in the development of the Training Manual for Home Economics, clothing and textiles for secondary school teachers in Malawi, specifically Family Resource Management, and Housing and Environment Modules. I also participated as an Editor of the manual that was developed.

11. **Consultant** – Midline Evaluation – Child Feeding Behaviours Qualitative Study, Njira (Pathways to Sustainable Food Security) Project.

Client: Project Concern International / USAID. **May – July 2019.**

Value: US\$4,550

Description of assignment and deliverables: Developed Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) and data collection tools (including their translation), trained the research team, collected qualitative data in Balaka, transcribed, coded and analysed the data, and wrote the report.

12. **Local Consultant** – External Quality Assurance for Support to Implementation of Social Protection for Ultra-Poor People in Malawi.

Client: GIZ (contracted to Syspons; sub-contracted to Kadale Consultants). **July 2019.**

Value: US\$1,147.50

Description of assignment and deliverables: Reviewed short project summary and briefing meeting with the consultant from Syspons; jointly conducted interviews and wrote interview notes; and discussed results with the international expert in light of the cultural and historical background of the country.

13. **Lead Consultant** – Endline Evaluation of the Inclusive Early Childhood Care and Development (IECCD) Programme.

Client: Save the Children International. **January – March 2019.**

Value: MWK11,852,000 (~US\$16,205.05)

Description of assignment and deliverables: Conducted an end-line study of the Inclusive Early Childhood Care and Development (IECCD) Project in Mzimba South and at the national level with the Ministry of Education, Science and Technology and the Ministry of Gender, Children, Disability and Social Welfare to assess the impact of the project and document lessons learnt for future programming. The evaluation employed the DAC Criteria of Evaluation and assessed effectiveness, impact and sustainability of the IECCD Project. Specifically, the evaluation: assessed the extent to which project outcomes and objectives were achieved; established factors that contributed to or hindered the achievement of the desired outcomes; assessed the impact of the project interventions at individual, community, district, and national levels; documented lessons learnt from the intervention for future programming of interventions; and drew recommendations for onward planning and scale-up.

14. **Monitoring and Evaluation Expert** – Baseline Survey for the Afikepo Nutrition Programme and Nutrition Sensitive Agriculture Component in Malawi.

Clients: University of Sydney, University of Malawi, UNICEF, and FAO. **October – December 2018.**

Value: Information not available

Description of assignment and deliverables: Supervised fieldwork; received and checked data for quality compliance, as well as meeting targets; and cleaned data in preparation for analysis.

15. **Qualitative Data Manager** – NVivo Remote Support for the Environment and Natural Resources Management (ENREM) Midline Evaluation.

Client: Kadale Consultants (sub-contracted by Mathematica Policy Research, USA). **2 May – 31 July 2018.**

Value: US\$2,700

Description of assignment and deliverables: Led the training of enumerators on translation, transcription, summarising, and coding in NVivo; supported the training on ethics, gender issues, handling uncooperative respondents, and sources of bias; managed and supervised data translation, transcription, coding and inter-coder reliability testing for 2/3 days after the pilot; conducted a one-day refresher training on coding in NVivo after the fieldwork was completed; and provided remote quality control checking of transcription and coding after fieldwork, and checking of theme summaries produced.

16. **Lead Consultant** – Monitoring the Implementation of the Essential Package Programme.

Client: Save the Children International. **January – July 2014.**

Value: US\$25,200

Description of assignment and deliverables: Monitored project activities for the Essential Package Programme in Zomba (TA Chikowi); supervised volunteers; conducted monthly community meetings; wrote and submitted monthly reports highlighting successes, challenges, and recommendations for programme improvement.

17. **Consultant** – Baseline Evaluation of the Impact of the Essential Package on Child Development and Protection Outcomes, Malawi Study.

Client: Save the Children International. **October – November 2013.**

Value: US\$25,200

Description of assignment and deliverables: Monitored project activities for the Essential Package Programme in Zomba (TA Chikowi); supervised volunteers; conducted monthly community meetings; wrote and submitted monthly reports highlighting successes, challenges, and recommendations for programme improvement.

18. **Consultant** – Evaluation of Capacity Needs in Early Childhood Education (ECE) in Malawi.

Client: Government of Malawi, Ministry of Gender, Children and Community Development. **September – November 2013.**

Value: information not available

Description of assignment and deliverables: supported the Team Leader with qualitative data analysis.

19. **Consultant** – Baseline Study: Gender Equality in Education Project.

Client: World Vision International – Malawi. April – **September 2013.**

Value: information not available

Description of assignment and deliverables: supported the Team Leader with qualitative data collection, report writing, and validation activities.

RESEARCH PROJECTS AND GRANTS

1. *Strengthening Malawi's ECD Management Information System (T4ECE)*

Role	Researcher <i>Tasks:</i> Data collection, analysis, reporting; attending monthly meeting with international partners, including ECD Measure and USAID.
Period	February 2024 – December 2024
Grant Value	US\$26,779.58
Funder	USAID – Together for Early Childhood Evidence (T4ECE), USA

2. *Child-to-Child Learning Approach: Scaling Up Inclusive Play-Based Learning for Smooth Transition from Pre-Primary to Early Grades (Uganda, Ethiopia, and Malawi)*

Role	Co-Investigator; Project Lead for Malawi
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	<i>Tasks:</i> Project implementation in Zomba and Chiradzulu; joint supervision with partners and monitoring; capacity building of caregivers, parents, and children; participated in baseline survey; led endline evaluation; participated in meetings with international collaborators; led manuscript development and authorship.
Period	May 2022 – November 2023
Grant Value	US\$94,755.43
Funder	International Development Research Centre (IDRC), Canada

3. *Complementary Feeding Bowl Pilot Project: Integration of an Infant and Young Child Feeding (IYCF) Toolkit as Part of the Social and Behaviour Change Package*

Role	Co-Investigator; Project Lead for Endline Evaluation <i>Tasks:</i> Project implementation in Dowa and Lilongwe; joint supervision with partners and monitoring; participated in baseline survey; led endline evaluation; participated in meetings with UNICEF and partners.
Period	November 2022 – November 2023
Grant Value	US\$135,000
Funder	UNICEF, Malawi

4. *Improving Secondary Education in Malawi (ISEM) Phase I & II – Continuous Professional Development (CPD)*

Role	Expert and Manual Editor <i>Tasks:</i> Contributed to the development of the Training Manual for Home Economics, clothing and textiles for secondary school teachers in Malawi, specifically Family Resource Management, and Housing and Environment Modules; and edited the Training Manual.
Period	December 2022 – November 2023
Grant Value	€36,409
Funder	European Union (EU)

5. *Energy Provision in Developing Countries: Understanding Private Sector Challenges of Scaling Up Energy Access in Uganda, Tanzania, and Malawi*

Role	Co-Investigator <i>Tasks:</i> Local coordination; coordination with international collaborators; data collection and report writing.
Period	June 2020 – June 2021
Grant Value	£5,000

Funder	Global Challenges Research Fund (GCRF), UK
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6. Promoting Farmers' Rights and Collective Marketing for Sustainable Food Security (Pro-Farmer Project)

Role	Monitoring and Evaluation Manager <i>Tasks:</i> Monitoring and supervision of project implementation; data collection, analysis, and report writing.
Period	June 2018 – June 2019
Grant Value	US\$120,000
Funder	Open Society Initiative for Southern Africa (OSISA)

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

SENIOR LECTURER, Department of Human Ecology and Agricultural Sciences
April 2026 – Present

School of Natural and Applied Sciences, University of Malawi, Zomba, Malawi

- Teaching and curriculum development in Children, Youth and Families; Family Ecology; and Ageing and Older Persons.
- Undergraduate and postgraduate student supervision, academic mentoring, and dissertation and thesis examination
- Departmental and faculty-level academic governance and committee service

LECTURER, Department of Human Ecology and Agricultural Sciences
May 2013 – March 2026

School of Natural and Applied Sciences, University of Malawi, Zomba, Malawi

- Teaching and curriculum development in Children, Youth and Families; Family Ecology; and Ageing and Older Persons.
- Undergraduate and postgraduate student supervision, academic mentoring, and dissertation and thesis examination
- Departmental and faculty-level academic governance and committee service

ASSOCIATE LECTURER, Department of Human Ecology and Agricultural Sciences

May 2008 – March 2013

School of Natural and Applied Sciences, University of Malawi, Zomba, Malawi

- Teaching and curriculum development in Children, Youth and Families; Family Ecology; and Ageing and Older Persons.
- Undergraduate and postgraduate student supervision, academic mentoring, and dissertation and thesis examination
- Departmental and faculty-level academic governance and committee service

UNIVERSITY SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

Current Roles

1. Postgraduate Coordinator, Human Ecology and Agricultural Sciences Department, School of Natural and Applied Sciences, University of Malawi (January 2026 – present). Duties include:
 - a) Coordinating admissions, supervision allocation, and academic progress monitoring for MSc Food Science students.
 - b) Reviewing and updating programme curriculum in line with national and international food science standards.
 - c) Facilitating postgraduate examinations, viva voce panels, and liaison with external examiners.
 - d) Mobilising research funding and supporting students and staff in developing competitive grant proposals.
 - e) Building partnerships with government ministries, research institutions, and development organisations relevant to food science and nutrition.
 - f) Preparing programme reports for Department, School, and Senate committees and ensuring compliance with University of Malawi postgraduate regulations.
 - g) Representing the programme at national and regional academic forums.
2. Member, University of Malawi Research Ethics Committee (UNIMAREC) (January 2026 – present). Duties include:
 - a) Reviewing and evaluating research proposals submitted by departmental staff and students for ethical compliance and scientific rigour.
 - b) Representing the Department of Human Ecology and Agricultural Sciences on the School and University-level UNIMAREC structures.
 - c) Ensuring departmental research activities adhere to national and international ethical standards governing human subjects research.
 - d) Providing ethical guidance to researchers on informed consent, confidentiality, data protection, and participant welfare.
 - e) Contributing to the development and review of institutional research ethics policies and procedures.
 - f) Facilitating ethical clearance processes for grant-funded and externally commissioned research projects within the department.
 - g) Supporting capacity building in research ethics among academic staff, students, and early-career researchers in the department.
3. Executive Member, School Committee on Open Days, Seminars and Conferences, School of Natural and Applied Sciences (February 2026 – present). Roles include:
 - a) Organising open days for the School.
 - b) Planning and coordinating School seminars.
 - c) Overseeing conferences hosted by the School.
4. Editorial Member, Malawi Journal of Science and Technology (February 2026 – present). Roles include:

- a) Reviewing and evaluating submitted manuscripts in line with the journal's editorial standards and publication ethics guidelines.
- b) Contributing to editorial policy decisions on manuscript acceptance, revision, and rejection, including identifying and recommending qualified peer reviewers across relevant disciplines.
- c) Supporting the promotion and indexing of the journal in recognised international databases to enhance its academic standing, citation impact, and visibility among national and international research communities
- d) Facilitating dissemination of journal publications among researchers, postgraduate students, funding agencies, and development partners, and contributing to special thematic editions aligned with emerging science and technology research priorities in Malawi.

Previous Roles

1. Head of Department, Human Ecology and Agricultural Sciences, School of Natural and Applied Sciences, University of Malawi (2021 – 2022). Duties:
 - a) Provide leadership with the Department of Human Ecology and Faculty of Science.
 - b) Coordinate all departmental academic activities, including the preparation of timetables and assessments of students.
 - c) Facilitate registration of students for all courses offered by the Department.
 - d) Counsel students in the Department.
 - e) Assist the Dean in the screening of research grant applications from members of staff from the Department before submission to the Research and Publications Committee (RPC).
 - f) Assist the Dean in ensuring that newly recruited staff are properly inducted.
 - g) Organise and chair departmental meetings.
 - h) Participate in the recruitment procedures as regards both academic and support staff for the Department and monitor their performances.
 - i) Prepare and control departmental budgets in consultation with the Dean, Registrar, and Finance Officer.
 - j) Initiate the introduction of new courses and programs in collaboration with staff in the Department and the Dean.
 - k) Lead in the regular review of departmental curricula.
 - l) Maintain discipline among academic and support staff in the Department in collaboration with the Dean and the Principal.
2. UNIMA-Wide Postgraduate Committee Member, University of Malawi (January 2019 – January 2021).
 - a) Contributing to the development and review of postgraduate policies, regulations, and academic standards across the University of Malawi.
 - b) Representing departmental and school-level postgraduate interests in university-wide deliberations on postgraduate education, research training, and quality assurance.
 - c) Contributing to strategic initiatives aimed at strengthening postgraduate research capacity, funding mobilisation, and academic excellence across the university.

- d) Supporting efforts to enhance the visibility, competitiveness, and internationalisation of University of Malawi postgraduate programmes for grant applications and research partnerships.
3. Faculty Representative for Postgraduate Studies, University of Malawi (January 2019 – January 2021).
 - a) Representing Faculty-level postgraduate interests in University-wide academic governance structures, policy deliberations, and strategic planning for postgraduate education.
 - b) Advocating for the strengthening of postgraduate research infrastructure, supervisory capacity, and funding opportunities across the faculty.
 - c) Liaising between faculty postgraduate programmes and University-level committees to ensure alignment of postgraduate training with national research priorities and international academic standards.
 - d) Contributing to grant mobilisation efforts and research partnerships that support the growth and sustainability of postgraduate studies within the Faculty.
 4. Faculty Representative, Research and Publications Committee (RPC), University of Malawi (January 2019 – January 2021).
 - a) Representing faculty research and publications interests in university-wide committee deliberations, contributing to the development of institutional research strategies and publication policies
 - b) Advocating for increased research funding, grant mobilisation, and external partnership opportunities to strengthen the faculty's research portfolio and publication output
 - c) Contributing to the review and dissemination of faculty research findings through peer-reviewed publications, conference proceedings, and policy briefs targeting academic, donor, and development audiences
 - d) Supporting the alignment of faculty research priorities with national development agendas, international funding frameworks, and emerging grant opportunities in the social, health, and applied sciences
 5. Patron, Human Ecology Students Society, University of Malawi (April 2010 – August 2010; June 2013 – January 2015; January 2019 – June 2021).
 - a) Providing academic mentorship and professional guidance to Human Ecology students, supporting their scholarly development, research competencies, and career aspirations in academia and the development sector.
 - b) Championing student engagement in research and knowledge dissemination activities aligned with the department's academic and scientific priorities.
 - c) Facilitating student participation in academic conferences, seminars, and community outreach activities that strengthen linkages between human ecology scholarship and national development priorities.
 - d) Supporting students in identifying and accessing postgraduate study opportunities, research funding, and professional networks in academia, government, and international development organisations.
 6. Faculty Representative, Careers Committee, Faculty of Science, University of Malawi (July 2008 – August 2010).

- a) Representing the Faculty of Science in university-wide careers committee deliberations, contributing to the development of institutional strategies that strengthen graduate employability and professional development pathways.
 - b) Facilitating linkages between the Faculty of Science and prospective employers, research institutions, funding agencies, and international development organisations to expand career opportunities for science graduates.
 - c) Supporting the integration of research, grant writing, and professional skills development into faculty career guidance frameworks to better prepare graduates for academic and development sector careers.
 - d) Contributing to the design and delivery of careers events, industry engagement forums, and academic mentorship initiatives that align faculty graduate profiles with national workforce development and research priorities.
7. Departmental Contact, Faculty of Science Newsletter, University of Malawi (July 2008 – August 2010).
- a) Sourcing and submitting departmental research highlights, grant achievements, academic publications, and staff and student accomplishments for dissemination through the Faculty of Science Newsletter.
 - b) Promoting the visibility of departmental research outputs, consultancy engagements, and scholarly activities to internal and external academic and donor audiences.
 - c) Liaising between the department and the Faculty newsletter editorial team to ensure timely, accurate, and impactful representation of departmental academic and research activities.
 - d) Contributing to the strengthening of the Faculty's research communication profile in support of grant mobilisation, academic partnerships, and institutional visibility.
8. Income Generating Activities (IGA) Director, Human Ecology Department, University of Malawi (March – August 2010; February 2013 – August 2014)
- a) Leading the identification, development, and management of income-generating activities within the Department of Human Ecology and Agricultural Sciences to strengthen departmental financial self-sufficiency and sustainability.
 - b) Overseeing the day-to-day operations of the departmental restaurant facility, ensuring consistent and quality provision of meals, snacks, and catering services to staff, students, and internal and external institutional meetings.
 - c) Managing operational logistics, including procurement, staffing, service delivery, and financial accountability of the departmental IGA restaurant
 - d) Ensuring the restaurant facility meets institutional hygiene, food safety, and quality standards in line with food science best practices and MBS compliance.

Thesis Examination

External Examiner: ‘Exploring Support Mechanisms in Rural Communities in Zambia for the Well-Being of Older People’. PhD Thesis, North-West University (NWU), South Africa.

- Conducted an independent external examination of the doctoral thesis titled “Exploring Support Mechanisms in Rural Communities in Zambia for the Well-Being of Older People”, assessing its theoretical grounding, methodological rigour, analytical depth, and contribution to gerontology and rural community studies in the African context.
- Provided a comprehensive examiner’s report with constructive scholarly feedback and recommendations on the thesis’s suitability for the award of the degree of Doctor of Philosophy.

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

1. **Lazaro, M.C.**, Nkhonya, H.K., Ejuu, G., Chibwana, K., Chibwana, A.I., & Sileti, J. (*in press*). Centre-based village and savings loans as a community-driven microfinancing mechanism of early childhood development and education in rural Malawi. *Malawi Journal of Education and Development*.
2. **Lazaro, M.C.** (*in press*). Children’s Engagement with Video Parlours and Intergenerational Conflict in Contemporary Rural Malawi: Cultural Erosion or Social Transformation? *Malawi Journal of Social Sciences*.
3. **Lazaro, M.C.** (2024). Corporal punishment of children in rural homes in Zomba, Southern Malawi: Moral socialisation or child abuse? *Malawi Journal of Social Sciences*, 23(2), 43–67.
4. Ejuu, G., Adela, R., **Lazaro, M.**, Mengstie, M.M., Mary, N., Jesca, A., & Miria, N. (2024). Scaling deep the Child to Child Approach to ease transition from pre-primary to lower primary in Uganda, Ethiopia and Malawi. *Journal of Education and Development*, 8(3), 20. <https://doi.org/10.20849/jed.v8i3.1443>
5. Hadfield-Hill, S., Finn, M., Dudman, J., Ergler, C., Freeman, C., Hayes, T.A., Jarman, P., Leon, L., **Lazaro, M.C.**, Latai-Niusulu, A., & Oza, E. (2023). Expanding the scope of ethical research with and for children and young people: six viewpoints on crisis, cross-cultural working and reciprocity. *Children’s Geographies*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14733285.2023.2259331>
6. **Lazaro, M.C.**, Walker, L., & Robson, E. (2023). Invisible in Plain Sight? Grandfathers Caring for Orphaned Grandchildren in Rural Malawi. *African Studies*, 82(1), 43–66. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00020184.2023.2212616>

Book Chapters

1. **Lazaro, M.C.** (accepted). Digital Ageism in Africa: Leapfrog Exclusion and Digital Equity for Older Adults. In L. Ayalon & C. Tesch-Römer (Eds.), *The Universal Nature of Ageism*. Springer Nature.

2. Durosaiye, I., Sadiq, K., Tekin, M., & **Lazaro, M. (in press)**. A Scoping Review of Ageing and Climate Change in Southern Africa. In R. Gilroy, C. Bigonnesse, & O. Jolanki (Eds.), *Research Handbook on Ageing and Housing*. Edward Elgar.
3. **Lazaro, M.C.**, Roy, S., & Ayalon, L. (*in press*). Climate Change, Poverty, Food Insecurity and Aging: Adaptive Strategies of Older Persons in Africa Amidst the Triple Jeopardy. In K. Pillemer & L. Ayalon (Eds.), *Handbook on Ageing and Climate Change*. Policy Press.
4. Kaparounaki, K., **Lazaro, M.C.**, & Levy, S. (2025). Unearthing Lived Experiences: Integrating Disability, Arts, and Social Work in Africa. In C. Baker, E. Imafidon, K. Moolman, & E.N. Samba (Eds.), *Activating Arts to Understand Disability in Africa: Inclusive Explanations* (pp. 99–111). Routledge.
5. Keating, N., Eales, J., Phillips, J., Ayalon, L., **Lazaro, M.**, Montes de Oca, V., Rea, P., & Tyagi (2021). Critical human ecology and global contexts of rural ageing. In M. Skinner, R. Winterton, & K. Walsh (Eds.), *Rural Gerontology: Towards Critical Perspectives on Rural Ageing*. Routledge (ISBN 9780367894795).

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

- Research Assistant – Baseline Evaluation, Malawi Farmer to Farmer Agroecology (MAFFA) Project, University of Malawi / University of Manitoba partnership. August 2013.
- Research Assistant – Family Functioning in Everyday Life (FFEL) Project, University of Alberta, Canada. January – April 2012.
- Research Assistant – Baseline Evaluation, Livelihoods Project, The Hunger Project, Malawi. March – April 2007.

EDITORIAL AND PEER REVIEWS

- Editorial Member – Malawi Journal of Science and Technology (February 2026 – present)
- Peer Reviewer – Journal of Humanities, University of Malawi (2025): one manuscript reviewed
- Peer Reviewer – Food Security Seminars, University of Malawi (2024): one manuscript and one abstract reviewed
- Peer Reviewer – Food Studies Seminar (2024): two abstracts reviewed
- Manual Editor – Improving Secondary Education in Malawi (ISEM) Phase I & II CPD Training Manual (2022)

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION AND PRESENTATIONS

1. Durosaiye, I., Sadiq, I., Tekin, M., & **Lazaro, M.** (2026). *A Scoping Review of Climate Change, Housing, and Ageing in Southern Africa*. From the Local to the Global: Ageing in an Interconnected World. British Society of Gerontology

55th Annual Conference, 24-26 June 2026, Oxford Brookes University, Oxford, UK.

2. **Lazaro, M.**, Robson, E., & Walker, L. **(2021)**. *Invisible in plain sight? Grandfathers caring for orphaned grandchildren in rural Malawi*. Development Studies Association (DSA) 2021 Annual Conference (Virtual), “Ageing and older age: unsettling development assumptions”. University of East Anglia, Norwich, England, June 14 - July 2, 2021.
3. Lazaro (2019). *Invisible in plain sight? Grandfathers caring for orphaned grandchildren in rural Malawi*. International Association of Gerontology and Geriatrics European Region (IAGG-ER) Congress 2019, 23-25 May 2019, Gothenburg, Sweden. ‘Towards Capability in Ageing – From Cell to Society’.
4. **Lazaro, M.C. (2018)**. *Grandfathers caring for orphaned grandchildren in rural Southern Malawi: Invisible in Plain Sight?* SES PhD Research Day – January 25, University of Hull, UK;
5. **Lazaro, M.C. (2017)**. *Exploring the emotional cost of researching in communities affected by HIV/AIDS and poverty in Malawi*. The 5th Annual Researchers in Development Network (RiDNet) Conference “I, Researcher: exploring the research experience - context, self and interdisciplinary practice” – January 27, University of Leeds, United Kingdom;
6. **Lazaro, M.C. (2016)**. *Learning with tears? The emotional cost of researching in communities affected by HIV/AIDS and poverty in rural Southern Malawi*. The Process and Challenges of Conducting Research on Africa: From the Library to the Field – November 3, Royal Holloway, University of London, United Kingdom;
7. **Lazaro, M.C. (2015)**. *Grandparenting in the Context of HIV/AIDS and Poverty: The Place of Grandfathers in Carework for Orphans and Vulnerable Children in Rural Southern Malawi*. PhD Symposium “Lightning Talk” — October 8, University House (Students’ Union Building), University of Hull, Hull, United Kingdom;
8. Kaombe, T.M., Simbeye, J., Ng’ambi, W.F., & **Lazaro, M.C. (2013)**. *Dealing with Household Correlations in Using Survey Data to Estimate Risk of Diarrhoea in Under-Five Children in Malawi*. SAMSA 2013 Conference, 25-29 November, Cape Town, South Africa;
9. **Lazaro, M.C.**, Skrypnek, B.J., & Williams, D. **(2011)**. *The Health Immigrant Effect: Changes of Immigrants and Refugees Health over Time*. The National Council for Family Relations 73rd Annual Conference “Families and the Shifting Economy” – November 16-19, 2011, Rosen Center Hotel, Orlando, Florida, US.

TRAINING/WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

1. The Discovery Hub Grant Writing Retreat, February 23-27, 2026, Malawi Liverpool Wellcome Programme – Lecture Theatre, CREATOR Building.
2. Write, Publish, Present Workshop, October 20-25, 2020, College of Medicine, University of Malawi, Blantyre, Malawi. Organised and funded by ACEPHAM.
3. Research Management Workshop, August 19-23, 2019, Mpale Cultural Village, Mangochi, Malawi. Organised by the Southern African Research and Innovation Management (SARIMA).

4. Master Class, International Association of Gerontology and Geriatrics European Region (IAGG-ER) Congress 2019, 23-25 May 2019, Gothenburg, Sweden. 'Portraying Old Age and Ageing to Counter Ageism.
5. *Colloquium: Demystifying Qualitative Analysis (Qualitative Analysis processes and approaches)* – May 25-26, 2017, University of Sheffield, United Kingdom.
6. The 4th Annual Researchers in Development Network (RiDNet) Conference "Conducting Fieldwork in Development Contexts: Expectations, Encounters & Entanglements" – November 30, 2015, University of Leeds, United Kingdom.
7. *Researching with Children and Young People in Diverse Socio-spatial Contexts*. ESRC-Funded Advanced Training Course in Theory and Methodology – September 24-25, 2015, Loughborough University, United Kingdom.
8. *Family Troubles: Care and Change in Diverse Contexts* – September 16, 2015, University of Reading, United Kingdom.
9. *The 6th PhD Experience Conference 2015* — April 7-8, 2015, University of Hull, UK.
10. *Knowledge Exchange Institute for Geriatric Nursing Medical & Social Work Education Conference* – May 4 to May 6, 2011, Brock University, Ontario, Canada.
11. *Nvivo for Qualitative Data Analysis* – November 2016, University of Hull, UK – 2015.
12. *Advanced Word Processing*, November 2016, University of Hull, UK – 2015.

MEMBERSHIP IN BOARDS AND ASSOCIATIONS

1. Interim Board Chairperson, Rural Empowerment and Action for Change (REACH) – 2021 to present.
2. Member, Research Management Network (supported by BRECCIA-GCRF) – 2021 – present).
3. Patron, Proactive Youth Association (PROYA) – 2022 to 2026.
4. Patron, Human Ecology Society, University of Malawi (2010-2012; 2013-2015; 2018-2021).
5. British Society of Gerontology (BSG) (July 2017 – 2018).
6. NVivo User Group, University of Hull, UK (February 2017 – 2018).
7. Royal Geographical Society (RGS) with Institute of British Geographers (IBG) (2015 – 2018).
8. The Southern Childhoods Network (September 2015 – 2018).
9. Research Network for Children, Youth, and Families (March 2015 – 2018).
10. Board Advisor, Centre for Child Development and Research (CCDR), Malawi (2013-2018).
11. Chairperson, Interim Committee on the Formation of Centre for Child Development and Research (CCDR), Malawi (2013).
12. Executive Member, Chinamwali Seventh-Day Adventist (SDA) Church, Zomba, Malawi (2014-2015).
13. Chairperson, Parents and Teachers Association (PTA), Chinamwali Private Nursery and Primary Schools, Zomba, Malawi (March 2013 – July 2013);
14. Assistant to Keynote/Plenary Presenter, Media Ecology Association 12th Annual Convention, University of Alberta, Canada (June 2011);

15. Patron for Seventh-Day Adventist (SDA) Club, Kasungu Secondary School (July 2007-April 2008).
16. Patron for Writers Union, Kasungu Secondary School, Kasungu, Malawi (July 2007-April 2008).
17. Deputy Leader of Communications, Chancellor College Seventh-Day Adventist (SDA) Church, University of Malawi, Zomba, Malawi (2005 – 2006).
18. Executive Member, Chancellor College Seventh-Day Adventist (SDA) Fundraising Committee, University of Malawi, Zomba, Malawi (2004 – 2005);
19. Coordinator, Zomba Adventist Students Organisation (ZASO), Zomba, Malawi (2003 – 2004).
20. Member, National Council on Family Relations (NCFR) (August 2011 to August 2012).
21. Member, Chancellor College Organisation for the Promotion of Early Childhood (COPEC) (2002–2006).

COMMUNITY OUTREACH

1. From 2019 to 2023, I served as a member of the Policy Advisory Team (PAT) on Nutrition in Malawi. In this capacity, I contributed to high-level policy discussions, offering technical input to inform nutrition strategies and interventions at the national level. These high-level discussions ensured that evidence-based perspectives were integrated into policy deliberations. Thus, I contributed to supporting efforts by the government and its partners in improving nutrition outcomes for children under five across the country.
2. Between 2020 and 2023, I was a core member of the team commissioned by the Government of Malawi and UNICEF to develop the Integrated Nutrition, Early Stimulation and Nurturing Training Manual. I also participated in the reviewing and editing of multiple draft versions of this Manual. This initiative strengthened national capacity for community-based nutrition and early childhood interventions. Later, I was invited by the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Welfare to serve as a Trainer of Trainers (ToT) for the Investing in Early Years Project (IEYP). During this task, I authored three modules for the training manual, namely: Modules 4 (Communication), 12 (Community Mobilisation and Empowerment), and 13 (Monitoring, Evaluation, and Supportive Supervision). I also facilitated training sessions to equip practitioners with skills in early childhood development (ECD), thereby enhancing the quality of service delivery to young children in the country.
3. In 2020, I represented the University of Malawi and participated in the 'Nutrition Roadmap Towards Attaining SDGs by 2030'. This national event was organised by the Ministry of Health and Population under the Department of Nutrition, HIV and AIDS (DNHA). My technical input supported strategic planning to accelerate national progress on key nutrition indicators in Malawi.
4. In 2020, I was opted in by the government through the DNHA to develop Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for Nutrition Programs during COVID-19 (2020). This work ensured continuity of essential nutrition services to children during the COVID-19 pandemic while adhering to public health guidelines.

REFEREES

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